

CC_Gift_Main (#153708)

Author(s)

This pre-registration is currently anonymous to enable blind peer-review.
It has 3 authors.

Pre-registered on: 2023/12/03 - 05:40 PM (PT)

1) Have any data been collected for this study already?

No, no data have been collected for this study yet.

2) What's the main question being asked or hypothesis being tested in this study?

We expect an interaction effect between women's conception probability (i.e., fertility) and their beliefs about what men notice on women's desire for conspicuous luxury brands. We propose that as women's fertility increases, women have increased desire for conspicuous luxury brands. However, the positive effect of fertility on desire for conspicuous luxury brands will be mitigated when women believe men do not notice designer clothes.

3) Describe the key dependent variable(s) specifying how they will be measured.

The dependent variable will be desire for a luxury (vs. non-luxury) brand: Participants will make a choice between Polo Ralph Lauren and Old Navy.

4) How many and which conditions will participants be assigned to?

There will be one between-subjects condition: control vs. a condition in which participants read that men do not notice when women wear designer clothes. We will also measure fertility.

5) Specify exactly which analyses you will conduct to examine the main question/hypothesis.

A regression will be conducted using fertility, experimental condition, and their interaction as the independent variables and desire for a luxury (vs. non-luxury) brand as the dependent variable.

6) Describe exactly how outliers will be defined and handled, and your precise rule(s) for excluding observations.

Pre-Screening Criteria for participation in the survey: We will only collect data from participants who fit the following eight criteria: (1) They are women between the ages of 18 and 40 (inclusive), (2) they are not currently taking hormonal contraceptives, (3) they have not taken hormonal contraceptives in the past three months, (4) they are not pregnant or breastfeeding a child, (5) they have not been sick in the past few days (e.g., with COVID-19 or the flu), (6) they have not been diagnosed with an endocrine or hormonal disorder (e.g., thyroid, ovarian, or pituitary conditions), (7) they do not have any other serious or chronic illness (e.g., cancer, diabetes, or neurological conditions), and (8) they do not currently take any prescription medication. These selection criteria are standard practice in ovulation research and are recommended in the literature (e.g., Durante & Arsena, 2015; Durante, Li, & Haselton, 2008; Durante, Griskevicius, Cantú, & Simpson, 2014; Durante, Griskevicius, Perilloux, & Li, 2011; Gangestad et al., 2016). Any people who do not fit these criteria will be prescreened and not allowed to participate. Given that we are interested in women's desire for conspicuous luxury brands, women who have not bought luxury brands in the past two years will also be prescreened.

Screening Criteria for the Analysis (i.e., people who do not pass the below criteria will take the survey, but will not enter the main analyses): We will only include women with regular ovulation cycles (i.e., between 25 and 36 days, inclusive), which is standard practice in this line of research. Moreover, we will only include women who are relatively certain (i.e., 6 or higher on a 9-point scale) about their reported period dates and usual cycle length.

7) How many observations will be collected or what will determine sample size? No need to justify decision, but be precise about exactly how the number will be determined.

We will collect a sample of N = 1,000 participants. We want 1,000 complete responses AFTER the pre-screening criteria for participation in the survey.

8) Anything else you would like to pre-register? (e.g., secondary analyses, variables collected for exploratory purposes, unusual analyses planned?)

We will also measure financial status with two items: "I don't need to worry too much about being able to pay my bills," and "I feel relatively poor these days". (1 = strongly disagree, 5 = strongly agree).